Getting Started with Microsoft Excel

(Navigate the interface and build your first structured workbook)

Overview

This course uses an artifact sequence approach in which participants build a complete, formula-driven workbook from a structured dataset. Learning progresses from navigating the Excel interface and writing essential formulas, to formatting data, organizing it as a table, and presenting and protecting the finished workbook. Each topic builds on the same artifact so participants understand how structure, formulas, and formatting work together to produce a reliable, professional output.

Objectives

Upon completion of the course, participants will be able to navigate the Excel interface and build a structured, formula-driven workbook from a practical dataset.

Specifically, participants will be able to:

- navigate the Excel interface and manage workbook files
- write and apply essential formulas to a structured dataset
- format data clearly using number, date, and cell formatting
- organize data as a table and protect the workbook for sharing

Who Should Participate

- Staff new to Microsoft Excel with no prior experience.
- Team members who use Excel informally and want a solid foundation.
- Professionals preparing to attend intermediate or advanced Excel courses.
- Anyone who works with structured data and needs reliable Excel skills.

Key Topics

I. Navigating the Excel Interface
   a. Identifying Ribbon tabs and command groups
   b. Navigating cells, rows, columns, and sheets
   c. Entering and editing data in cells
   d. Saving and naming workbooks correctly

II. Writing Essential Formulas
   a. Typing SUM, AVERAGE, MIN, MAX formulas
   b. Using AutoFill to extend formula patterns
   c. Applying relative and absolute references
   d. Wrapping outputs in IFERROR

III. Formatting Data for Clarity
   a. Applying number, date, and currency formats
   b. Formatting cells using Home tab tools
   c. Applying borders and cell background colors
   d. Adjusting column widths and row heights

IV. Organizing Data as a Table
   a. Converting a range to a table via Insert → Table
   b. Using table column references in formulas
   c. Sorting data using Data → Sort
   d. Filtering rows using Data → AutoFilter

V. Presenting and Protecting the Workbook
   a. Creating a bar or column chart from a table
   b. Adding axis titles and data labels to charts
   c. Freezing rows using View → Freeze Panes
   d. Protecting a sheet with Review → Protect Sheet